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OVER 200 DEAD IN SRI LANKA; SOUTHEAST ASIA FLOOD TOLL TOPS 600

Flood-affected people evacuate after heavy rainfall in Wellampitiya on the outskirts of Colombo, Sri Lanka. Devastating monsoon floods and landslides across Southeast Asia have pushed the death toll past 600 as rescue and clean-up operations continue in Indonesia, Thailand and Malaysia. Thousands were left stranded, many waiting for help on rooftops as swollen rivers burst their banks and entire communities were submerged. In Sri Lanka, at least 212 people have died and more than 200 remain missing after Cyclone Ditwah triggered heavy rains, flash floods and mudslides across the island. **SEE ALSO P11**

UAE reaffirms support for a Palestinian state

PRESIDENT'S LETTER TO UN EMPHASISES NATION'S STAND

ABU DHABI
Gulf News Report

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan has reaffirmed the UAE's steadfast support for the Palestinian people and their legitimate aspirations and inalienable rights.

In a letter to the Chairman of United Nations Information System on the Question of Palestine, Sheikh Mohamed stressed that the UAE remains committed to the Palestinian people's right to self-determination, and the establishment of an independent Palestinian state with East Jerusalem as its capital, in accordance with the two-State solution and relevant UN resolutions.

The letter comes on the International Day of Solidarity with the Palestinian People (UNISPAL).

Sheikh Mohamed stressed that the UAE remains committed to the Palestinian people's right to self-determination, and the establishment of an independent Palestinian state with East Jerusalem as its capital.

UNISPAL is the world's largest online repository of documents on the question of Palestine.

It was established and is maintained by the Division for Palestinian Rights in response to successive General Assembly mandates.

The main collection contains the texts of current and historical United Nations material concerning the question

of Palestine and other issues related to the Middle East situation and the search for peace. UNISPAL contains the English texts with a growing number in the other official UN languages.

Toll crosses 70,000

The health ministry in Hamas-run Gaza on Saturday said more than 70,000 people have been killed since the war between Israel and Hamas erupted more than two years ago. The milestone comes as a fragile US-brokered ceasefire largely holds, but with both sides accusing the other of violating the terms of the deal.

In a statement, Gaza's health ministry said the death toll from the war had risen to 70,100. The ministry said that since the ceasefire came into effect on October 10, 354 Palestinians had been killed by Israeli fire.

SEE ALSO P10

UAE among top holiday-home markets

Global study highlights nation's appeal driven by safety, hospitality, lifestyle offerings

DUBAI
BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

The UAE has been ranked the fourth most attractive destination in the world for buying holiday homes, according to a new global study by Property Finder. The study, which assessed 32 countries, underscored the UAE's rising status as a preferred hub for living, investment and travel, supported by favourable regulations, high living standards and

4th

UAE's rank, behind Spain, France and Portugal

exceptional connectivity. The analysis measured affordability, transport infrastructure, rental returns, tax burdens and quality-of-life indicators.

While the top three places were secured by long-established tourism destinations, the UAE's entry into the leading group reflects the effectiveness of its modern development model, economic stability and high-quality urban planning.

Spain topped the global ranking, supported by its Mediterranean climate, extensive coastline and 50 Unesco's World Heritage sites. France followed in second place, celebrated for its cultural wealth and historical landscapes, while Portugal ranked third for its relaxed lifestyle, scenic beaches and celebrated golf resorts.

US ranks behind UAE

The US placed fifth, bolstered by its diverse geography from Florida to California and Colorado. Property Finder's analysis highlights a clear shift in buyer priorities, with long-term safety, mobility, transparency and stability now outweighing natural scenery alone — areas in which the UAE excels.

NATION

President, Vice-President and Rulers hail sacrifices of UAE martyrs | P4

IN FOCUS

Pivotal moments as UAE celebrates 54 years of unity | P8-9

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UAE airlines complete A320 safety updates as normalcy returns | P-1

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